

D. — Head of Operations, Marlowe & Co.

WEEKLY 1:1 • 30 MINUTES • YOUR DIRECT REPORT

What it already knows: every past 1:1, his open commitments, the threads he is on, and how he communicates when the pressure is on. This is the part most people walk in without.

Where he stands

Owns operations for the brand: inventory, production, purchasing, and the rollout of the new fulfillment system. The last month has a pattern worth naming.

Purchasing fix on the cotton supplier — caused the production gap on the bedding line

OVERDUE • 14D

Fulfillment-system rollout plan — moving, but without urgency

AGING • 11D

Inventory reconciliation handoff to finance — missed last week

AGING • 7D

He committed to the purchasing fix back in your 5/22 1:1; this is the third week it has carried over, and the production gap it caused cost roughly two weeks of bedding inventory ahead of the spring push. Not on a formal plan yet, but the trend is building, and that is why this one matters more than the last few.

How to approach him

The part you cannot get from a status report. Pulled from how he has actually shown up across past 1:1s, plus how it reads his communication style under pressure.

Keep it private and direct. In the Monday ops standup he goes quiet and defensive when a miss surfaces; one-on-one he opens up. Do not raise any of this in front of

the team.

Hand him ownership, not criticism. He leans in when you give him a concrete problem to own; he deflates under vague "do better" feedback. Name the problem, then give it to him.

Lead with the business, then the ask. He reads *steady, methodical, risk-aware* — he wants to be sure before he commits, which is why he goes silent rather than over-promise. Yours runs *faster, people-first, quicker to move*. Open with why it matters to the brand, give him a beat to process, then make the specific request, not the gap.

Read the silence. The tell is not what he says, it is where he goes quiet. Across your last three 1:1s (5/8, 5/15, 5/22) he went silent the moment the cotton supplier came up. That is where the real issue is. Go there gently, and let him fill it.

Before you walk in, ask it: "What is the best way for me to approach him on purchasing?"

It has the context — every thread, every prior 1:1, his communication pattern. Let it shape the opener so you are not winging the hardest part of the conversation.

This conversation's goal: accountability, not feedback

Leave with three commitments, each a deliverable and a date. Not "tighten up purchasing." A specific fix, owned, by a specific day.

Feedback fades by Friday. A dated, owned commitment is something you can both come back to.

Frame it as backing him, not catching him. "Here is what I need owned, and here is how I will help you get there." Accountability and support in the same breath.

What to raise — and how to frame it

The purchasing gap (overdue 14 days). Name the downstream cost — the bedding-line stall it caused going into the spring push — then ask him to own the fix with a

date. Do not relitigate why it slipped.

The fulfillment rollout (aging 11 days). Ask what is blocking it, not why it is late. Blockers are a problem to solve together; lateness is a thing to defend.

The missed reconciliation handoff. One-off, or a pattern forming? Ask, then listen for where he goes quiet.

Watch-outs

Make it a tracked plan, not a note. This is near-plan territory. Capture it as a structured plan with deliverables and dates — it gives him a clear path and gives you a record if it has to escalate.

Put the recap in writing the same day. So the three commitments are on the record, not just in the room.

COMMAND ROOM • 1:1 PREP • BUILT FROM EVERY PAST 1:1, HIS
COMMITMENTS, AND HIS PROFILE • NAMES AND FIGURES ARE ILLUSTRATIVE